

Iran War — Energy & Regional Security Timeline

Alert Window: Today · Generated: 2026-03-18 07:30:02

Situation Brief

The current escalation level in the Iran-Israel-US conflict is critical, primarily driven by Iran and the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), which have conducted missile and drone strikes across the Gulf, signaling a direct threat to energy security and oil supply routes. Recent Iranian missile attacks on Israel, in retaliation for assassinations, further exacerbate tensions and pose risks to market stability in the Middle East. The U.S. response, involving strikes on Iranian coastal missile sites, indicates a heightened military engagement that could disrupt oil infrastructure and transit through the Strait of Hormuz. With WTI and Brent crude prices reflecting structural tightening in the market, immediate implications for crude prices are evident amidst increased volatility. The most important development to watch next is the potential for further Iranian military actions and U.S. responses, which could significantly impact regional energy dynamics.

AI-generated from deterministic classification data · 2026-03-18 07:30:02

Critical Developments (Next 24–48h Focus)

Iran Missile Strikes on Gulf Oil Supply Routes

The recent missile and drone strikes by Iran across the Gulf pose a direct threat to oil supply routes, risking immediate disruptions that could affect global oil markets and increase prices rapidly.

U.S. Military Strikes on Iranian Coastal Sites

The U.S. strikes on Iranian missile sites escalate military engagement, raising the risk of retaliatory actions that could further jeopardize transit through the Strait of Hormuz, a critical chokepoint for global oil shipments.

Iranian Attack on Israel Heightens Regional Tensions

Iran's missile attack on Israel in retaliation for assassinations increases the likelihood of broader military conflict, which could destabilize the Middle East and disrupt energy markets, impacting supply chains within 24-48 hours.

AI-generated from classified event data · 2026-03-18 07:30:02

Market Snapshot

As of Mar 18, 2026 06:34 Eastern Daylight Time
Market Regime: Structural Tightening (Distillate Driven)

WTI 94.30	Brent 103.55	Nat Gas 2.96
VIX 21.52	10Y 4.20	Dollar 99.74

Refining Spread: +67.8 (Extreme Distillate Tightness)

SYSTEM STRESS

Jet Fuel 3.86 ~162/bbl	Cheniere (LNG) 251.38	BDRY ETF 10.39
------------------------------	--------------------------	-------------------

Situation Summary

Events Detected: 29
High Severity: 29
Primary Actor: Iran/IRGC
Actor Concentration: 100% Iran/IRGC
Escalation Level: Critical
Market Regime: Structural Tightening

Event Timeline

EVENT CLUSTER — Iran still seen capable of escalating attacks on Gulf’s energy

SEVERE IRAN/IRGC MILITARY VERIFIED

Mar 18 5:00 · HIGH · immediate · Al Jazeera, WRAL, Al Jazeera
Iran's continued capability to escalate military attacks in the Gulf poses a significant threat to energy security, potentially disrupting oil supply chains and heightening regional tensions.
21 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 1 of 5

EVENT CLUSTER — Iran launches ‘revenge’ missile attack on Israel after assassinations

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

IRAN STRIKE

VERIFIED

Mar 18 5:00 · HIGH · immediate · Al Jazeera, dw.com

The recent missile strike by Iran on Israel in retaliation for assassinations significantly heightens regional tensions, posing an immediate risk to energy market stability and security in the Middle East.

2 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 2 of 5

EVENT CLUSTER — Australian troops safe after Iranian missile strikes near base in the UAE

SEVERE

IRAN/IRGC

IRAN STRIKE

CORROBORATED

Mar 18 5:00 · HIGH · immediate · The Guardian, The Times of India, 9News

The Iranian missile strikes near a UAE base heighten regional tensions and could disrupt energy supply chains, prompting immediate market volatility and increased security concerns for oil producers in the Gulf.

3 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 3 of 5

EVENT CLUSTER — Iran’s strikes on the UAE reflect a clash between two visions for the Middle East

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

GULF IMPACT

CORROBORATED

Mar 18 5:00 · HIGH · immediate · thenationalnews.com, Middle East Eye

Iran's recent strikes on the UAE signify a critical escalation in regional tensions, potentially tightening energy market dynamics and heightening security risks for Gulf oil supplies.

2 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 4 of 5

EVENT CLUSTER — U.S. Hits Iranian Coastal Missile Sites With Bunker-Buster Bombs

ELEVATED

IRAN/IRGC

MILITARY

VERIFIED

Mar 18 5:00 · HIGH · immediate · gCaptain

The U.S. military's recent strikes on Iranian coastal missile sites significantly heighten regional tensions, posing an immediate risk to energy supply routes and market stability in the Gulf.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 5 of 5

Iran War Reference

Iran Oil Exports: ~1.5-2M bbl/day (sanctions-constrained) · Primary buyers: China, Syria

Key Infrastructure: Kharg Island terminal ~90% of exports · Abadan refinery · Isfahan refinery

Nuclear Sites: Fordow (underground) · Natanz · Arak heavy water reactor

US Forces: 3 carrier strike groups · Fifth Fleet (Bahrain) · ~40,000 troops in region

Chokepoint Risk: Strait of Hormuz ~21M bbl/day · Iran controls northern shore

Gulf State Exposure: Saudi ~9M bbl/day · UAE ~3M bbl/day · Kuwait ~2.5M bbl/day · Iraq ~4M bbl/day

Proxy Network: Hezbollah (Lebanon) · Houthi (Yemen) · PMF (Iraq) · Hamas (Gaza)

Iran War — Energy & Regional Security Timeline

This report is provided for informational purposes only and does not constitute investment, trading, or financial advice.

© 2026 Randy Hinton. All rights reserved. · https://petroai1492.github.io/delta/iranwar_timeline.pdf